



AFTER

In the years following the war, the U.S. Navy was cut from 626 to 60 vessels, and most of the 65 ironclads were scrapped or sold. But the surge of innovation driven by the war spread to navies all over the world.

IRON AND STEEL

By the 1890s, the **revolution in naval design** had reconfigured warships across the globe. Gone were masts and sails; vessels were now **built entirely of steel**, strong as iron but lighter, and powered by steam. Guns were housed in armored turrets or protected by armored shields called "barbettes."

TORPEDOES

Speedy torpedo boats, designed to attack the lumbering new battleships, launched **self-propelled torpedoes**, refined in Europe while the Civil War was still being fought. **Improved naval mines** became ubiquitous in blockade operations and harbor defense, particularly after the 1904–05 Russo-Japanese War.

SUBMARINES

Engineers continued to design new and improved submarines throughout the rest of the 19th century. But it was only in 1900 that a submersible was deemed **reliable enough to be put into service by the U.S. Navy**.